

Chapter 44

Trimming

Most editors would agree that trimming is half the job of editing.

While you can make many kinds of changes in the Timeline using the selection and razor blade tools, there is a dedicated Trim mode in which you can perform more sophisticated trim operations in fewer steps using either the mouse or keyboard shortcuts, depending on how you like to work. Mastering DaVinci Resolve's trimming operations will save you time when doing the necessary work of fine-tuning your edit.

Contents

Summarizing Trim Operations	916
Selection-Based Trimming Using the Trim Tool	916
How the Trim Tool Differs From the Selection Tool	917
Using the Trim Tool With the Mouse	918
Turning Off the Heads Up Display While You Trim	922
The Precision Trim Editor	922
Trimming Edits in the Timeline Viewer.....	922
Trim Tool Operations With the Keyboard	923
Important Trimming Keyboard Shortcuts	924
Trimming Using Timecode Entry	926
How to Enter Timecode Values	926
Commands to Make Selections and Trim	927
Trimming Clips in the Source Viewer	928
Ripple Editing Rules	929
Using Auto Select Controls to Control Trimming	931
Using Auto Select to Control Which Clips Are Trimmed.....	931
Using Manual Selections to Control Which Clips Are Trimmed.....	933
Using Auto Select to Control Which Tracks Are Rippled	933
Trimming Multiple Edits or Clips at Once	935
Resizing and Rolling Multiple Edit Points	936
Rippling Multiple Edit Points.....	936
Asymmetric Trimming	938
Slipping Multiple Clips	940
Sliding Multiple Clips.....	940

Keyboard Trimming During Looped Playback.....	941
Dynamic JKL Trimming.....	941
Quick Trimming.....	942
Dynamic Trimming (or “JKL Trimming”).....	943
Trim Operations that are Targeted Using the Playhead.....	944
Trim Start and Trim End.....	944
Resize, Ripple, and Roll Start and End Commands.....	946
Slip and Slide Playhead to In and Out Commands.....	946
Extend Edits.....	946

Summarizing Trim Operations

Before going into the different methods of trimming that are available, users who are new to editing might benefit from a quick summary of what each trimming operation actually does. Each trim operation is designed to let you move edits and clips in relation to whichever clips are around them, by performing several operations at once. The five primary methods of trimming are:

- **Resize:** Shortens or lengthens the end of an outgoing clip or the beginning of an incoming clip, while either overwriting a neighboring clip or leaving a gap behind as necessary. While this isn’t usually included in a discussion of “trim” operations, it’s actually the simplest kind of trimming you can do.
- **Roll:** Moves an edit point to the left or right by either shortening the outgoing clip while lengthening the incoming clip, or vice versa. Roll edits do not change the duration of the overall Timeline.
- **Ripple:** Shortens or lengthens the end of an outgoing clip or the beginning of an incoming clip, while simultaneously moving all clips either to the right in the Timeline (if you’re rippling to lengthen a clip) or left in the Timeline (if you’re rippling to shorten a clip) to fill the gap or prevent overwriting that would otherwise occur if you were doing a resize operation. Ripple edits do change the duration of the overall Timeline and can alter the sync relation between different tracks if you’re not careful.
- **Slip:** Keeps a clip in the same place in the Timeline, while changing the range of media that appears in that spot. Slip edits do not change the duration of the overall Timeline.
- **Slide:** Keeps a clip’s range of media the same, but moves that clip to the left or right by either shortening the outgoing clip to its left while lengthening the incoming clip to its right, or vice versa.

Selection-Based Trimming Using the Trim Tool

Trim mode differs from Selection mode in that operations that would move clips with the Selection tool will either slip or slide clips with the Trim tool. Other operations that would resize edits with the Selection tool instead ripple the Timeline to automatically close gaps when using the Trim tool. The following sections describe the various trim operations that are available, both when using the mouse, and when using the keyboard.

To enter Trim Edit mode:

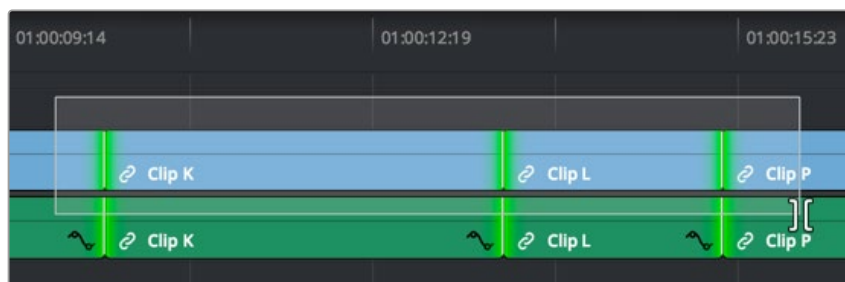
- Click the Trim Edit button, or press the T key.

How the Trim Tool Differs From the Selection Tool

Aside from the actual trimming operations that are available, there are a few other important differences between the Trim tool and the Selection tool.

Selecting Edit Points

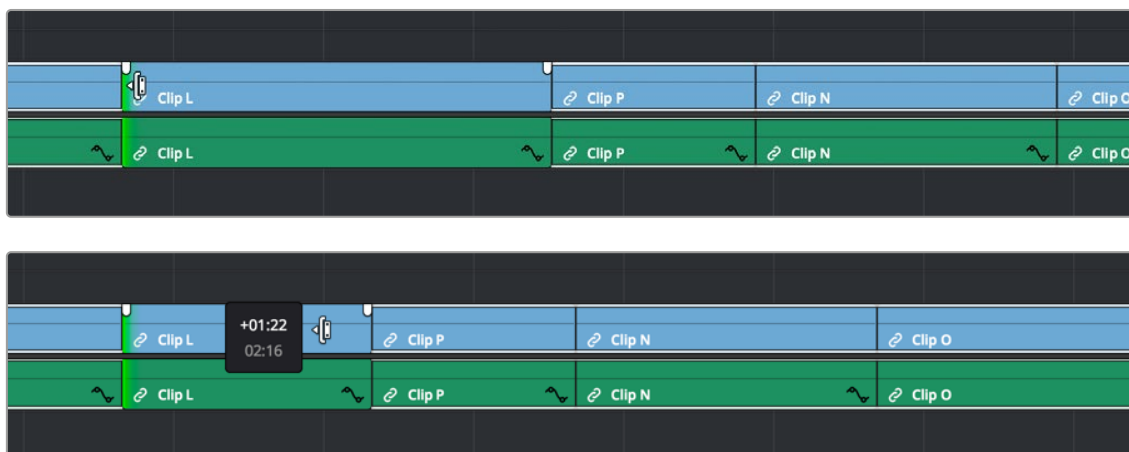
When the Trim tool is selected, dragging a bounding box over a series of clips in the Timeline selects the edit points to join clips together, instead of the clips themselves. This makes it fast and easy to select multiple edit points that you want to operate on simultaneously.



Selecting edit points in the Timeline using the Trim tool

Rippling the Timeline With Different Operations

When the Trim tool is selected, other commands and controls that would ordinarily resize a clip or clips and leave gaps in the Timeline instead move (ripple) clips that are to the right of the clip or edit you're trimming over to the left to prevent gaps whenever clips or edits are moved or resized.

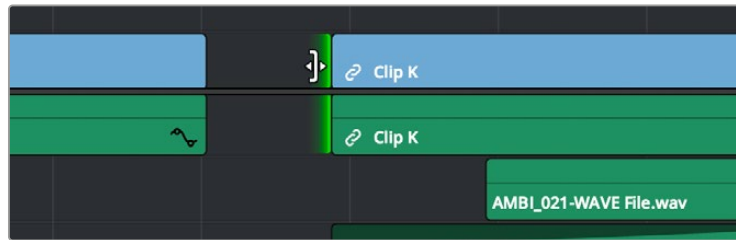


Rippling the incoming edit point of Clip L to resize it and prevent a gap from appearing by moving all clips that are to the right (Clips P, L, and N) over to the left

For example, the Retime controls, the Extend and Trim Start/End commands, and the Nudge keyboard shortcuts all work differently depending on whether you're using the Selection or Trim tools. This lets you use one set of tools to do different operations, depending on what you need to do.

Rippling Gap

You can also use the Trim tool (or other trim operations described later in this chapter) to ripple the start and end of a gap in the Timeline. Rippling a gap lets you grow or shrink the gap while moving the portion of the Timeline to the right of the gap forward or backward in time. Whenever you ripple against gap, a 2-up display appears that lets you see both the clip you're trimming and whatever superimposed clips may be showing through that gap.



Using the Trim tool to ripple the Out point of a gap to narrow it

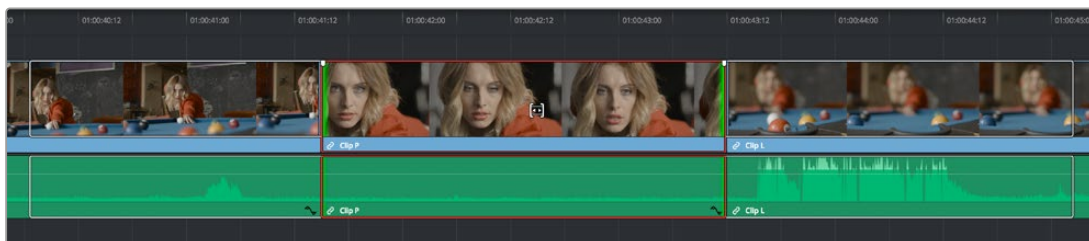
TIP: You can temporarily toggle between the selection (A) and trim tools (T) while using these operators to see their effects. Releasing the key will return you to the originally selected mode.

Using the Trim Tool With the Mouse

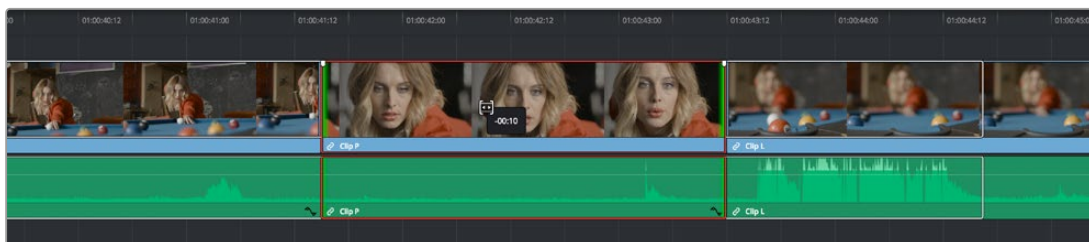
When trimming using the mouse, you can perform every kind of trim operation that's available using a single tool, simply by clicking the Trim mode/tool button, and then dragging on the appropriate area of a clip in the Timeline.

Methods of trimming with the mouse in Trim Edit mode:

- **To slip a clip:** To slip a clip's range of content without changing its position in the Timeline, click the middle top region of a clip, and then drag to the left or right to "slip" the clip to contain a different range of frames. A dashed overlay shows the total duration of media available for you to slip with, which moves left and right as you drag.



Clicking the top clip area before a slip, an overlay shows the clip's available range of media



After dragging to slip, clips don't move, but the slipped clip's range of media has changed

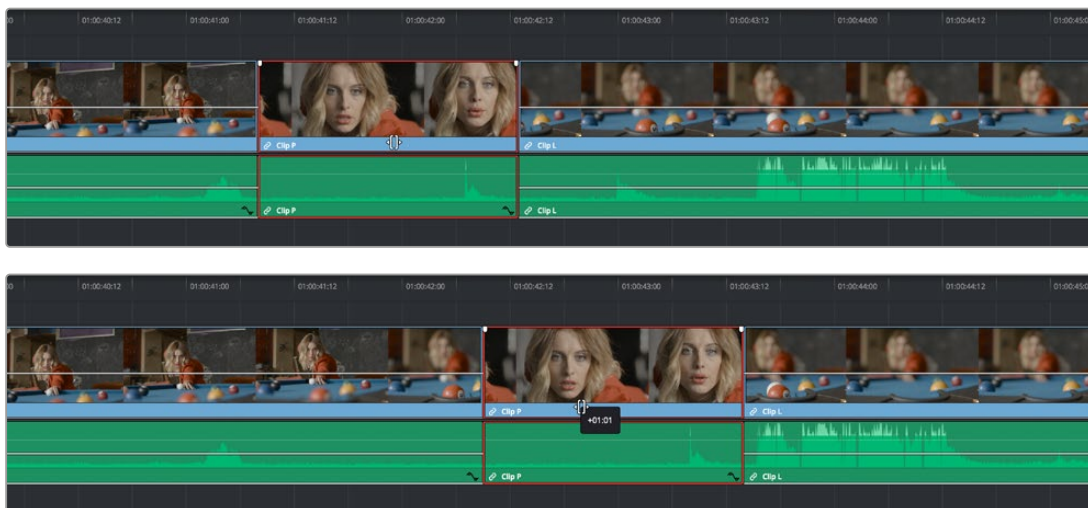
When slipping clips, a 4-up display shows all relevant outgoing and incoming frames, so you can compare the continuity of action from one clip to the next. During a slip, the top two frames update to show you the new incoming and outgoing frames of the clip being slipped, relative to the unchanging outgoing frame of the clip to the left and incoming frame of the clip to the right.

TIP: You can temporarily disable this four-up display by pressing the Shift key while you slip so that you only see the frame at the position of the playhead. This makes it possible for you to see which frame passes the playhead by as you ripple the Timeline. You can toggle this two-up display off completely by selecting View > Enable Multiview Edit Preview.



Four-up display when slipping a clip

- **To slide a clip:** To slide a clip, moving it to another position in the Timeline while simultaneously adjusting the Out point of the previous clip and the In point of the next clip to accommodate the change in position of the current clip being dragged, click the bottom-middle name bar of the clip and drag it to another position.



After dragging to slide, the selected clip is at a new location, surrounding clips filled the gap

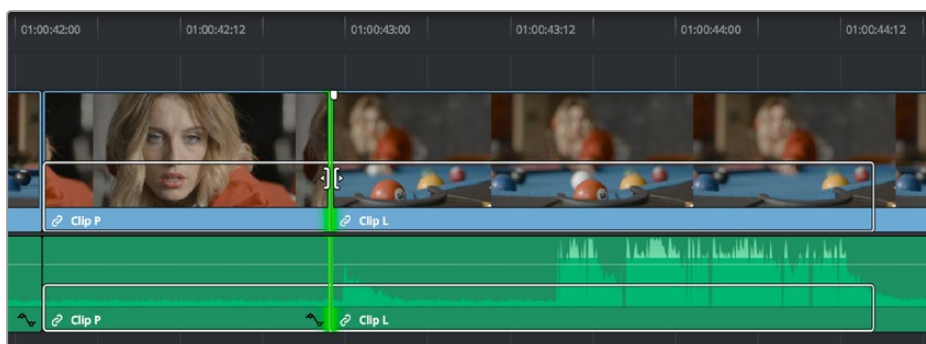
When sliding clips, a 4-up display shows all relevant outgoing and incoming frames, so you can compare the continuity of action from one clip to the next. During a slide, the bottom two frames update to show you the new outgoing frame of the clip to the left, and the new incoming frame of the clip to the right of the clip being slid.

TIP: You can temporarily disable this four-up display by pressing the Shift key while you slide so that you only see the frame at the position of the playhead. This makes it possible for you to see which frame passes the playhead by as you ripple the Timeline. You can toggle this two-up display off completely by choosing View > Enable Multiview Edit Preview.

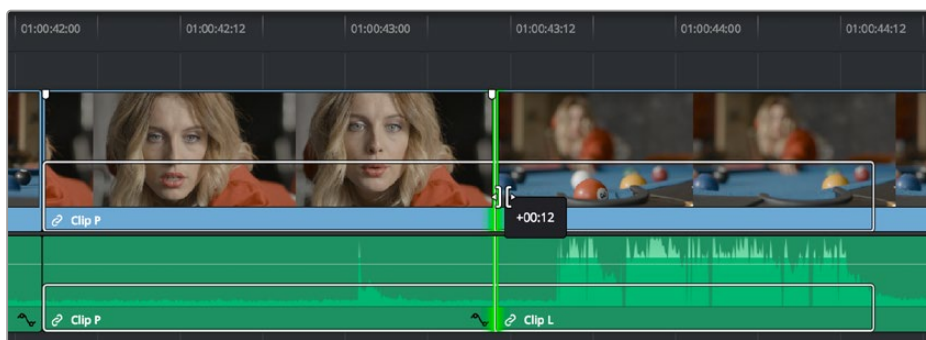


4-up display when sliding a clip

- **To roll an edit point:** To roll an edit, moving the Out point of the outgoing clip and the In point of the incoming clip at the same time, drag an edit point between two clips to the left or right. (Roll edits can also be done in Selection mode.)



Selected edit point before roll



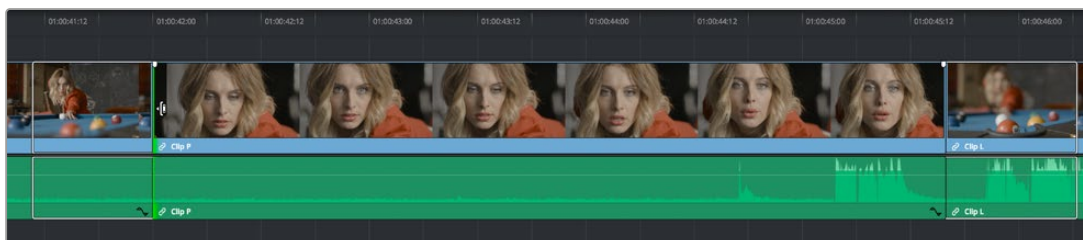
Edit point moved farther to the right, both adjacent clips resized to prevent gap

When rolling an edit, a 2-up display shows the changing continuity of action from the outgoing frame of the clip to the left to the incoming frame of the clip to the right, and you will hear the audio scrubbing of the right clip.

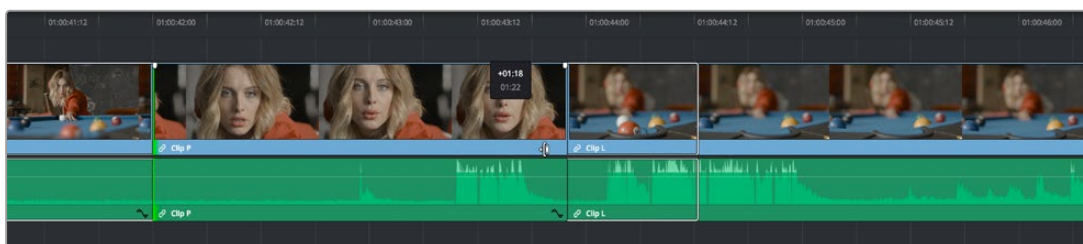


Two-up display when rolling an edit

- **Ripple edit:** To ripple the outgoing or incoming part of an edit to add or remove media to a clip while simultaneously moving all other clips at the left in the Timeline to make room, click the Trim tool, and drag an edit point to a new position in the Timeline.



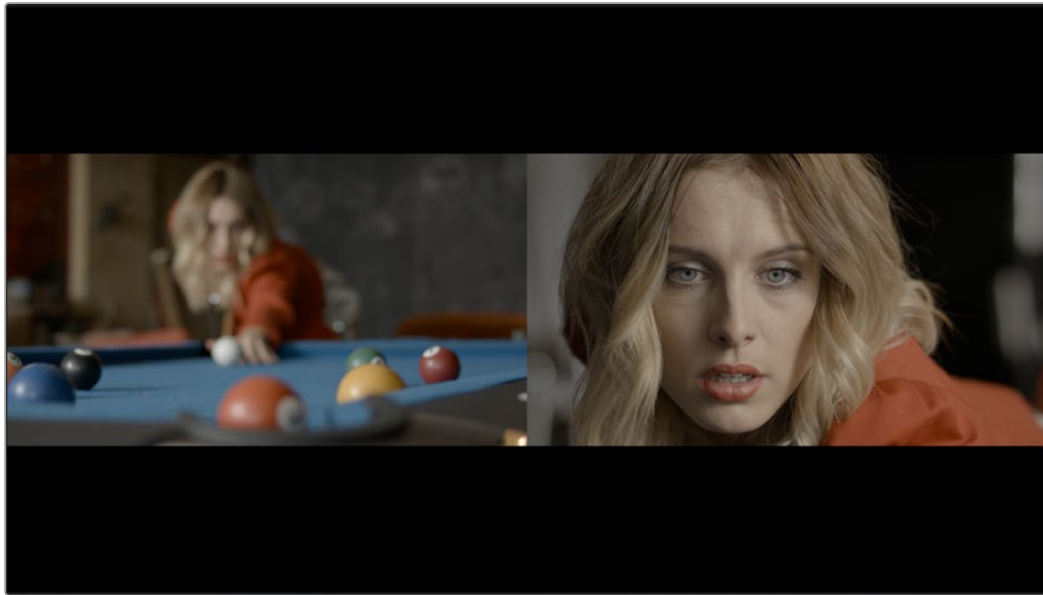
Selected outgoing half of an edit point before ripple



Rippled clip is shorter, the rest of the Timeline has moved left to fill the gap

When rippling an edit, a 2-up display shows the continuity of action from the outgoing frame of the clip to the left to the incoming frame of the clip to the right. Which frame updates depends on which side of the edit you're rippling.

TIP: You can temporarily disable this two-up display by pressing the Shift key while you ripple so that you only see the frame at the position of the playhead. This makes it possible for you to see which frame passes the playhead by as you ripple the Timeline. You can toggle this two-up display off completely by selecting View > Enable Multiview Edit Preview.



Two-up display when rippling an edit

Turning Off the Heads Up Display While You Trim

If you press the Shift key while performing most drag and trim operations, you can suspend the multi-frame heads up displays that appear in the Timeline window in order to focus on the frame that intersects the playhead.

To toggle the two- and four-frame heads up displays off or on:

- Choose View > Enable Multiview Edit Preview.

The Precision Trim Editor

An enhanced trim mode similar to the Cut page's precision trim editor is available in the Edit Page viewer, allowing you to see a large display of frame changes on either side of your edit.

To access it, double-click an edit point, or choose "Trim Editor" from the Trim menu on the selected edit point.

Trimming Edits in the Timeline Viewer

You can double-click any edit point between two clips in the timeline to open up the Trim Editor, which provides a detailed method of adjusting both halves of an edit point. A graphical A/B roll interface shows two filmstrips with the outgoing clip on top and the incoming clip on the bottom.

These controls are draggable:

- Drag the left side of the top filmstrip's handle to trim the Out point of the outgoing clip.
- Drag the right side of the bottom filmstrip's handle to trim the In point of the incoming clip.
- Drag the white handle between the top and bottom filmstrips to roll the edit point, simultaneously adjusting the outgoing and incoming edit points.

Numbers over each frame let you see exactly how many frames you're trimming, while a pair of buttons to the left and right of the transport controls in the Viewer toolbar let you adjust the outgoing clip's Out point and incoming clip's In point in one frame increments.



The Viewer Trim Editor, seen when you double-click an edit in the timeline

Trim Tool Operations With the Keyboard

You can also perform every trim operation more precisely using the Nudge keyboard shortcuts.

To trim with the keyboard:

- 1 Press T to select the Trim tool.
- 2 To trim the selection, do one of the following:

To slide a clip: Press Shift-V to select a clip, and press the Comma key to slip it one frame to the left, or the Period key to slip it one frame to the right. Shift-Comma and Shift-Period slips the clip in 5-frame increments.

To slip a clip: Press Shift-V to select a clip, then press the S key to toggle to Slip mode (pressing S again toggles back to Slide mode) and press Comma or Period to slide its contents to the left or right. Shift-Comma and Shift-Period slides the contents in 5-frame increments.

To roll an edit: Press V to select an edit point, then press the Comma key to nudge it one frame to the left, or the Period key to nudge it one frame to the right. Shift-Comma and Shift-Period rolls the edit in 5-frame increments.

To ripple an edit: Press V to select an edit point, then press U to select either the incoming or outgoing side of the edit by itself. Then, press the Comma key to ripple the selected In or Out point of the clip to the left, or the Period key to ripple it one frame to the right. Shift-Comma and Shift-Period ripples in 5-frame increments.

- 3 If you want to suspend the 2- or 4-up display that appears in the Timeline Viewer while trimming, you can Choose View > Enable Multiview Edit Preview to toggle the trimming displays off and on.

TIP: When holding down the Shift key while nudging to do a “fast nudge,” the duration of the nudge is customizable in the Editing panel of the User Preferences. By default it’s five frames, but you can set it to whatever you want.

Important Trimming Keyboard Shortcuts

When trimming using the keyboard, the following keyboard shortcuts are important for you to remember. Most of these commands, and many more that haven’t been assigned to keyboard shortcuts, can also be found in the Trim menu. You can remap many of these commands to different keyboard shortcuts using the Keyboard Mapping panel of the User Preferences. For more information, see *Chapter 4, “System and User Preferences.”*

Key Shortcut	Function
T	Trim mode, ripples edits and slips or slides clips.
A	Selection mode, resizes edits and moves clips.
Command-L and J	Fast trim commands, lets you dynamically trim the selection at 100% forward and reverse speeds.
W	Dynamic trim or resize mode, uses JKL to trim the selection.
S	Toggles between Slip and Slide mode when a clip is selected in Trim mode.
V	Selects the edit point closest to the playhead, and moves the playhead there.
Shift-V	Selects the clip or gap that intersects the playhead. If there are superimposed clips, turn off the Auto Select controls of tracks containing clips you don’t want to select.
Shift	A modifier that temporarily disables the 2- and 4-up display that appears when trimming edits and clips with either the pointer or keyboard shortcuts.
Option-F1 through F9	Toggles Auto Select for video tracks 1 through 9, making it possible to restrict certain selection and trim operations performed with the keyboard.
Command-Option F1 through F9	Toggles Auto Select for audio tracks 1 through 9, making it possible to restrict certain selection and trim operations performed with the keyboard.

Key Shortcut	Function
U	Toggles the currently selected edit point among the outgoing, centered, or incoming part of the edit.
Option-U	Toggles the currently selected edit point or clip among Video+Audio, Video Only, or Audio Only.
Comma (,)	After you've made a selection, nudges selected edits or clips one frame to the left. Shift-Comma nudges 5 frames (the duration is customizable in the Editing panel of the User Preferences).
Period (.)	After you've made a selection, nudges selected edits or clips one frame to the right. Shift-Period nudges 5 frames (the duration is customizable in the Editing panel of the User Preferences).
Forward-Slash (/)	This command works contextually depending on what's selected in the Timeline. Plays a section of the Timeline from x frames before to y frames after (a) the playhead (if nothing's selected), (b) the currently selected edit point, (c) the currently selected clip, (d) a selection of multiple clips. This command is useful for previewing how the current selection plays within the context of the clips immediately surrounding it. The pre-roll and post-roll time is customizable in the Editing panel of the User Preferences.
Command-/	Toggles looped playback off and on.
Down Arrow, Up Arrow	Moves both the playhead and selection state to the next or previous edit point. If multiple clips or edits are superimposed, the first clip on the lowest numbered track will be selected first, then the next clip up, and so on until the topmost superimposed clip is selected, before selecting the next clip in the Timeline.
E	Extend edit. Resizes or ripples selected edit points to the current position of the playhead.
Shift-[	Trim Start. Resizes (Selection) or ripples (Trim) the In point of all clips on auto-select-enabled tracks that intersect the playhead to the position of the playhead.
Shift-]	Trim End. Resizes (Selection) or ripples (Trim) the Out point of all clips on auto-select-enabled tracks that intersect the playhead to the position of the playhead.
Shift-Command-[	Ripple Trim Start. Regardless of whether Selection or Trim mode is enabled, always ripples the In point of clips on auto-select-enabled tracks that intersect the playhead to the position of the playhead.
Shift-Command-]	Ripple Trim End. Regardless of whether Selection or Trim mode is enabled, always ripples the Out point of clips on auto-select-enabled tracks that intersect the playhead to the position of the playhead.

IMPORTANT: While the Slip, Roll, and Slide tools will change the sync relationship of the clips you're adjusting with a matching soundtrack, the rest of the Timeline won't be affected. Using Ripple can alter the overall sync relationship of large portions of your timeline and its matching soundtrack, so you should use it with extreme care.

Trimming Using Timecode Entry

You can also use absolute or relative timecode entry to trim clips and edits. What is trimmed depends on the selection you've made prior to entering timecode. If you want to use timecode to trim the selection forward relative to its current position, be sure to type an equal sign or plus (= or +) before the timecode value; to trim the selection backward relatively, type minus (–) before the timecode value.

- **To roll an edit:** Select the center of an edit point, enter a timecode value, and press Return.
- **To ripple an edit:** Select either the outgoing or incoming half of an edit point, enter a timecode value, and press Return.
- **To slip a clip:** Select a clip, and press S if necessary to switch to Slip mode, enter a timecode value, and press Return.
- **To slide a clip:** Select a clip, and press S if necessary to toggle to Slide mode, enter a timecode value, and press Return.

How to Enter Timecode Values

When entering timecode, type each pair of hour, minute, second, and frame values from left to right, with a period representing a pair of zeros for fast entry. The numbers you enter appear in the timecode field at the upper right-hand corner of the Viewer with focus. When you're finished typing, press the Enter key to execute the timecode command. The rules for timecode entry are as follows:

- The right-most pair of timecode values (or period) you enter is always the frame number.
- A period to the left or to the right of any number you type is considered to be a pair of zeroes.
- A single period between two numbers is considered to either be a single zero or ignored if it's between two pairs of numbers.
- Any untyped pairs of values to the left of what you enter are assumed to be whatever those values were prior to the timecode you entered; this makes it easy to type partial timecode values even when the Timeline starts at hour one.
- It's not necessary to enter colons or semicolons.

IMPORTANT: With full length keyboards, you can use the number pad for implicit timecode entry without invoking the Go To Timecode action (=). When using a multicam or printer light operation, any already mapped number pad key will continue to invoke actions like switching angles or incrementing color values.

When using the number keys above the letters on a keyboard, you must first select Go To Timecode (=) or click in the field you wish to change before entering a new value.

Absolute timecode is entered simply by typing in a timecode value. So long as no clips or edit points are selected when you press the Return key, the playhead will move to that timecode value. If an edit point or clip is selected, those will be moved or trimmed to the corresponding timecode value, if possible.

Here are some examples of absolute timecode entry using this method:

Original TC Value	User-Typed Value	New TC Value
01:10:10:10	15245218	15:24:52:18
01:10:10:10	2..	01:02:00:00
01:10:10:10	15	01:10:10:15
01:10:10:10	12	01:10:10:12
01:10:10:10	1.2	01:10:01:02
01:10:10:10	115..	01:15:00:00
01:10:10:10	23...	23:00:00:00

Relative timecode is entered by starting the timecode value with a plus (+) or minus (–). Adding a plus results in the value you type being added to the current timecode value for purposes of offsetting the playhead or moving a selection. Adding a minus will subtract the value you type from the current timecode value.

Here are two examples of relative timecode entry:

+20. 00:00:20:00 is added to the current timecode value.

–5 00:00:00:05 is subtracted from the current timecode value.

Commands to Make Selections and Trim

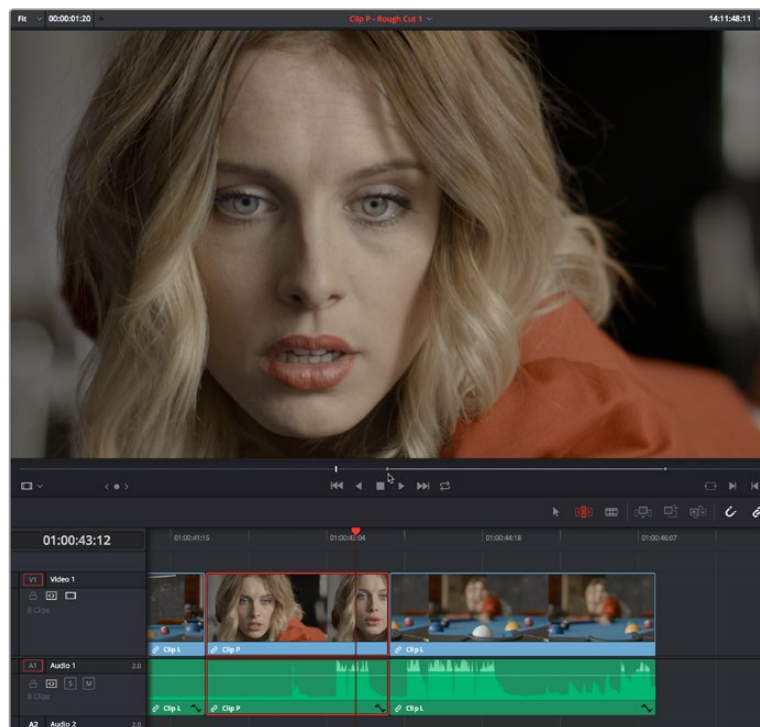
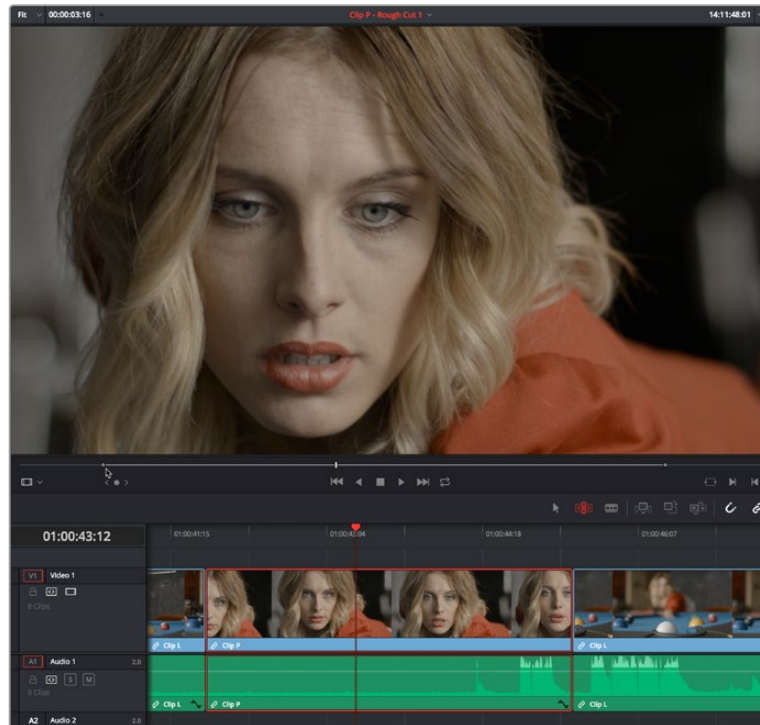
A series of commands in the Trim menu make it fast to automatically select the In or Out point of the clip that's nearest to the current position of the playhead, and go into either Selection or Trim mode in preparation for resizing or ripple trimming that edit point. These commands are:

- Select Nearest Edit to Resize In
- Select Nearest Edit to Resize Out
- Select Nearest Edit to Ripple In
- Select Nearest Edit to Ripple Out
- Select Nearest Edit to Roll
- Select Nearest Clip to Move
- Select Nearest Clip to Slip
- Select Nearest Clip to Slide

These commands are similar to using the Edit Selection (V) or Clip Selection (Shift-V) keyboard shortcuts along with those for choosing the Selection (A) or Trim tool (T) both at once, to get you ready for trimming in the way that you want. However, they have the added benefit of, in some cases, letting you specifically choose the In or Out points of the clip nearest the current position of the playhead. These commands don't have keyboard shortcuts by default, but if you prefer this way of working, you can assign them to keyboard shortcuts of your choosing using the Keyboard Customization tool (Option - Command - K).

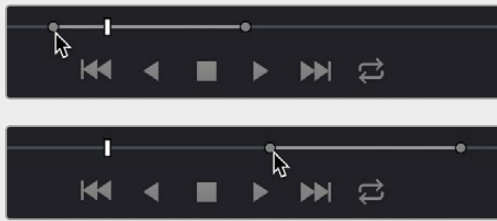
Trimming Clips in the Source Viewer

Additionally, you can double-click a clip in the Timeline to open it into the Source Viewer for trimming. When the Selection tool is selected, you can drag the In and Out markers, or use the playhead and I and O keyboard shortcuts to resize that clip in the Timeline. With the Trim tool selected, you can ripple the In and Out points of the clip.



A Timeline clip being ripple-resized by opening it into the Source Viewer dragging its In point using the Trim tool

You can slip the contents of the clip by holding the Shift key down and dragging either the In or Out point.



A Timeline clip being slipped by opening it into the Source Viewer and Shift-dragging its In point using the Trim tool

NOTE: To open a match frame of a clip that's part of an edited sequence into the Source Viewer using the mouse, hold the Option key down while double-clicking a clip in the Timeline.

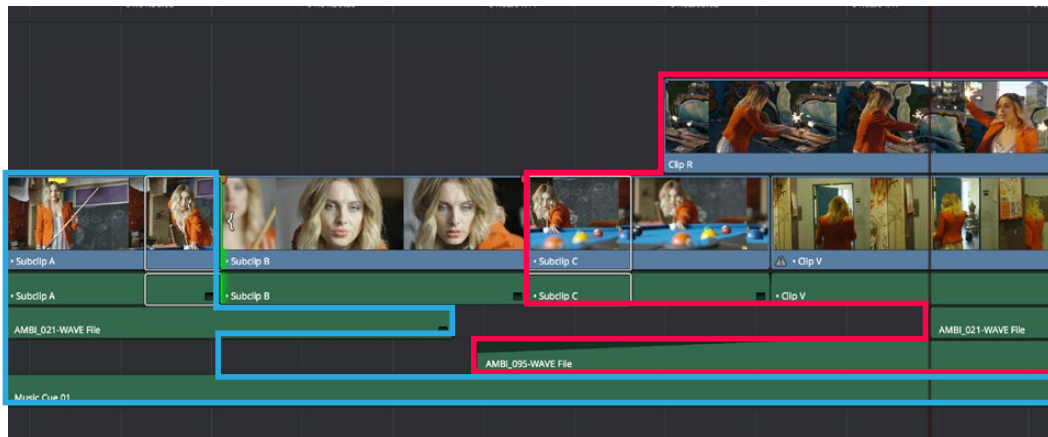
Ripple Editing Rules

Ripple operations are the only trim functions that change the duration of the overall Timeline, and that can potentially alter the sync relationship between multiple clips on different tracks. This makes them incredibly useful, but it's important to understand which parts of the Timeline will move as part of a ripple operation, and which parts won't.

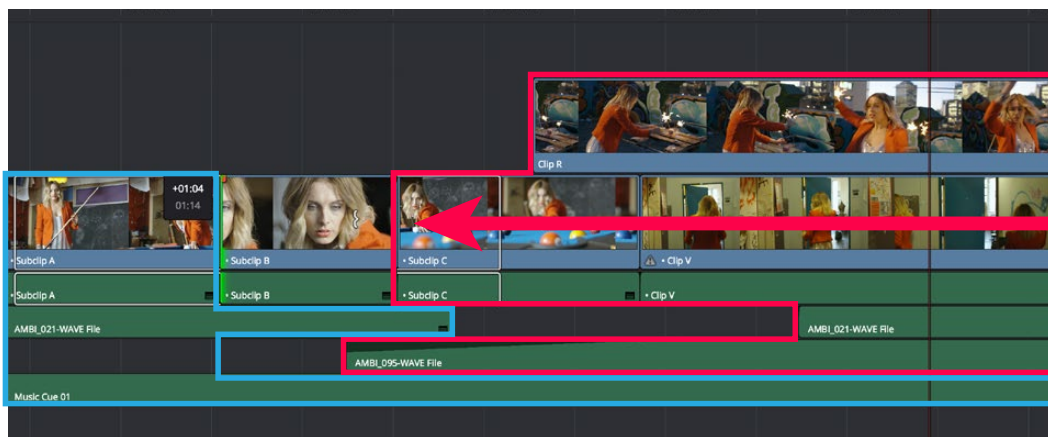
The following operations ripple the Timeline:

- Ripple deleting a clip or gap (Forward-Delete)
- Ripple cutting a clip (Shift-Command-X)
- Rippling one or more edits or gaps using the Trim tool (press T to choose the Trim tool)
- Using the Extend Edit (E), Trim Start (Shift-[]), or Trim End (Shift-]) commands in Trim mode
- Using the Ripple Start (Command-Shift-[]) or Ripple End (Command-Shift-]) commands in any mode
- Performing an insert edit (F9) or ripple overwrite edit (Shift-F10)
- Using the Retime controls to speed up or slow down a clip in Trim mode
- Using the Change Speed dialog with the Ripple Sequence checkbox turned on
- Changing clips in a Take Selector with the Ripple control enabled

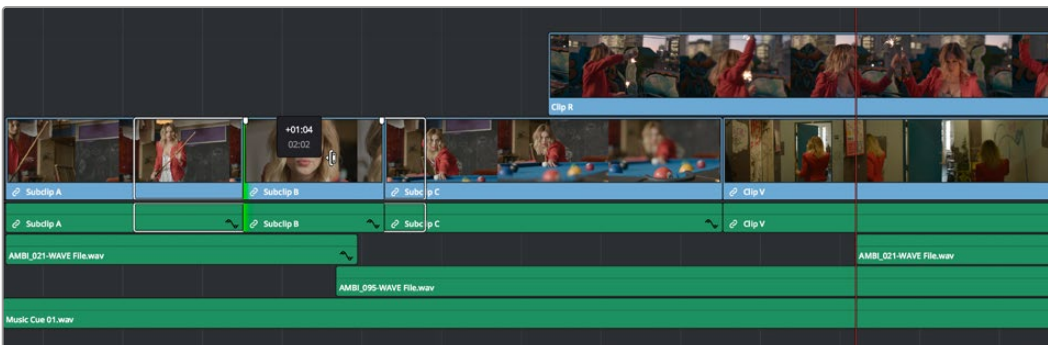
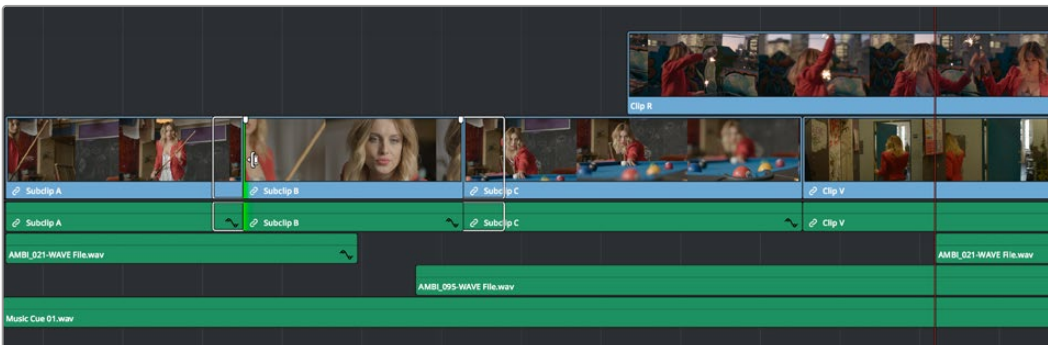
During a ripple edit, superimposed clips with an In point that's to the left of the edit point or clip being rippled are not moved. This can be seen in the previous example via the audio clip at the bottom of the Timeline, which stays in place even as the clips on track V1 and A1 are rippled. All clips with In points to the right of the edit point or clip being rippled move left to follow the trim operation you're making.



Before Ripple



After Ripple



The rules of timeline rippling illustrated. All clips with In points to the left of Subclip B (the clip being rippled) are left in place (area in blue), while all clips to the right of the edit being rippled are moved by the duration of the ripple operation (in red)

This simple rule means that, if you're in the habit of building sequences of clips from left to right, long overlapping superimpositions such as titles, graphics, and music clips will stay in place while you're rippling various clips within a montage that you're editing in relation to these longer clips.

However, there's one exception to this rule. It is often the case that split edits, where linked audio and video are cut at different places, create a situation where the audio In point of a pair of linked audio and video items precedes a video In point that you want to ripple. In other words, the audio In point extends to the left of the video In point, which ordinarily would trigger the rule that clips with edit points to the left of a rippled edit point won't be moved, which would throw the audio and video of this item out of sync. In this case, you probably want to maintain sync, so all items that are linked to a clip being rippled always ripple along with it, even if they do have In points that extend to the left of the edit point being rippled.

Using Auto Select Controls to Control Trimming

The Auto Select buttons on each track in the Timeline control a host of different operations, but while they're deceptively powerful, they're also among the most misunderstood controls of the Timeline. When a track's Auto Select control is on, clips on that track are automatically included in three different types of operations:

- Operations that affect clips intersecting the position of the playhead
- Operations that affect clips intersecting a region defined by timeline In and Out points
- Operations that ripple clips to the right of an affected clip on the Timeline

When a track's Auto Select control is off, clips on that track are ignored by those same categories of operations, unless you manually select one or more clips or edit points.

The next three sections go into detail on how the Auto Select buttons help you control the trimming operations described in this chapter, particularly when it comes to operations that ripple the Timeline, and the kinds of "playhead-targeted" trim operations described later in this chapter.

For more information on using the Auto Select controls to define selections and control other editing operations, see *Chapter 36, "Editing Basics."*

Using Auto Select to Control Which Clips Are Trimmed

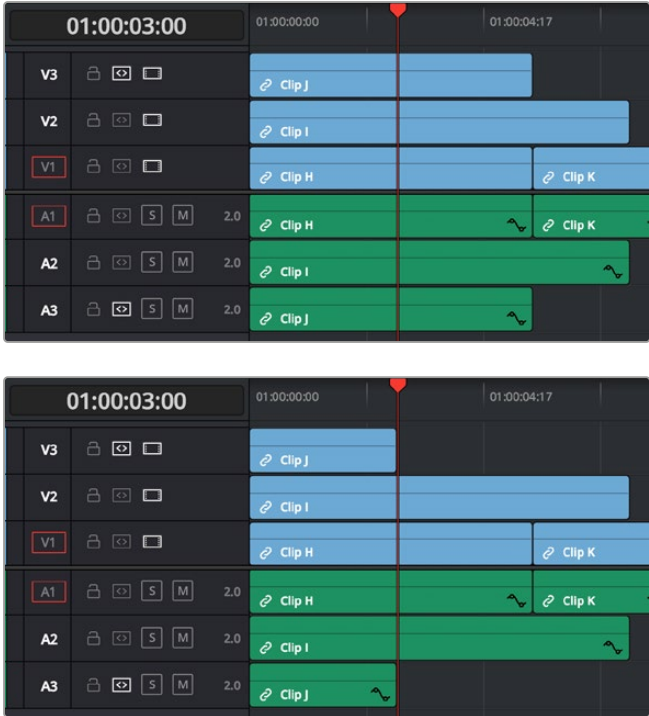
One of the principal uses of the Auto Select controls is to let keyboard shortcut-driven editors choose which specific clips on which tracks will be affected by an operation that would otherwise affect every superimposed clip at the position of the playhead or encompassed by In and Out points set in the timeline.

For example, if multiple clips are superimposed in V1, V2, and V3, and A1, A2, and A3, all six tracks have their Auto Select controls turned on, and you park the playhead over one of them and use the Trim End command in Selection mode, then all six superimposed clips will be trimmed.



Trimming all clips at the position of the playhead

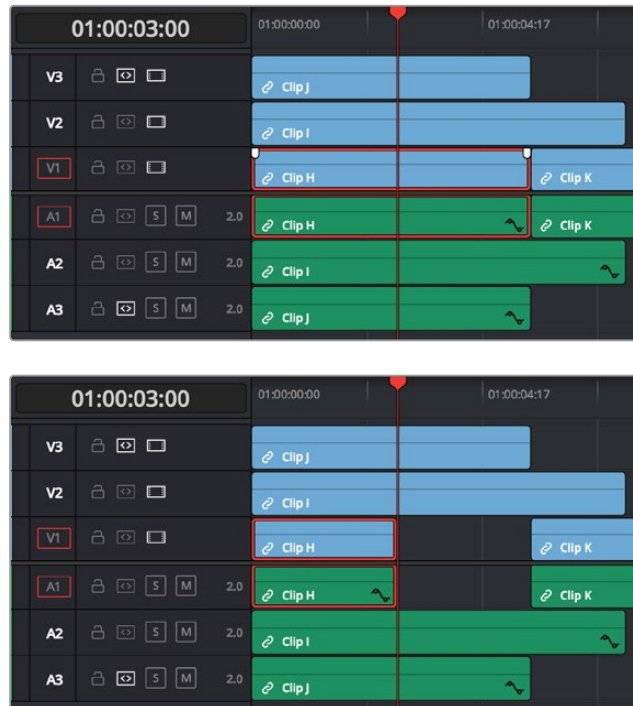
However, if you only want to trim the clip in track V3, then you can solo the Auto Select control of V3 by Option-clicking it, and then when you use the Trim End command, the clip on V3 is the only one that's trimmed, the other clips are ignored.



Trimming only the clip in V3 by soloing the V3 Auto Select controls

Using Manual Selections to Control Which Clips Are Trimmed

It's important to know that manual selections you make in the Timeline that highlight specific clips always take precedence over whatever the Auto Select controls are set to. For example, if Auto Select is turned on for tracks V1, V2, and V3, but you've selected a clip on track V1, only the selected clip will be still be affected by whatever operation you decide to perform. For example, if you use Trim End, the clip on track V1 will be affected.



Manual selection of a clip on track V1 overrides the Auto Select controls on all tracks

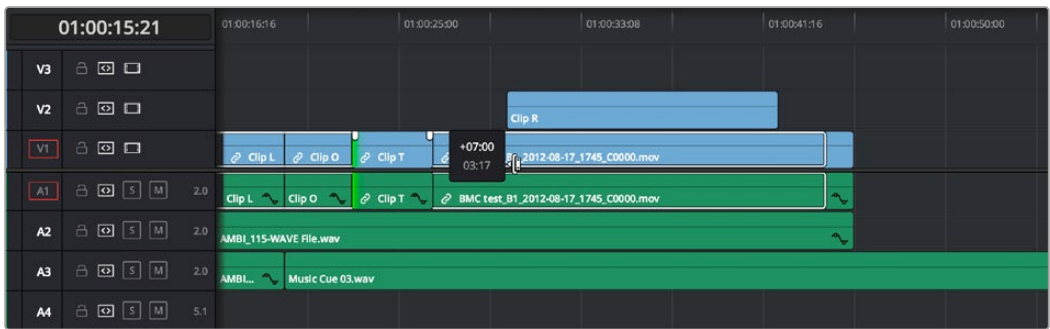
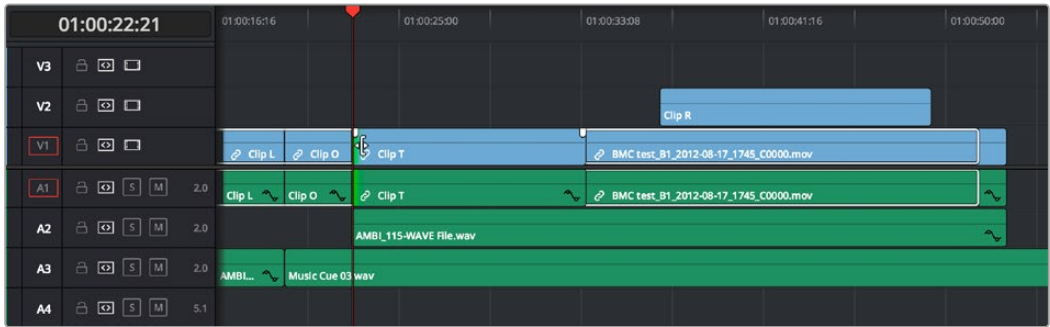
Using Auto Select to Control Which Tracks Are Rippled

Each track's Auto Select control is also used to control how trimming and editing operations that ripple the Timeline affect timelines with multiple tracks and superimposed clips. Using Auto Select controls, you can turn off rippling on specific tracks, while leaving it on for others.

For ease of use, you'll typically want to leave Auto Select on for all tracks when rippling clips, to ensure that all the parts of your timeline stay in sync with one another. However, when the occasion requires, the Auto Select controls provide the option to suspend rippling on specific tracks while allowing rippling on others.

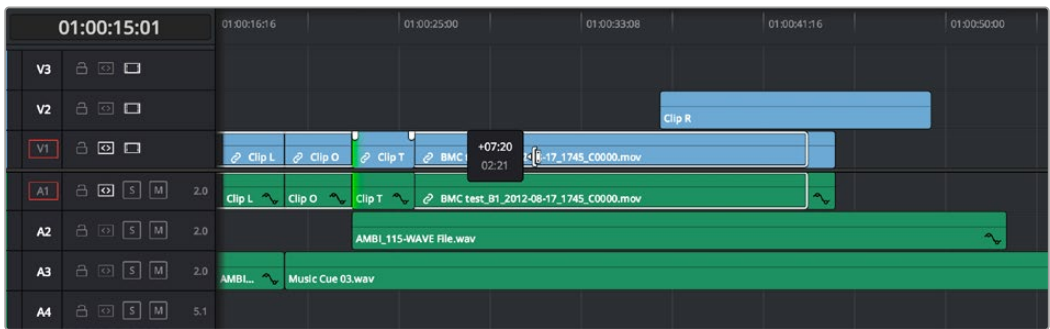
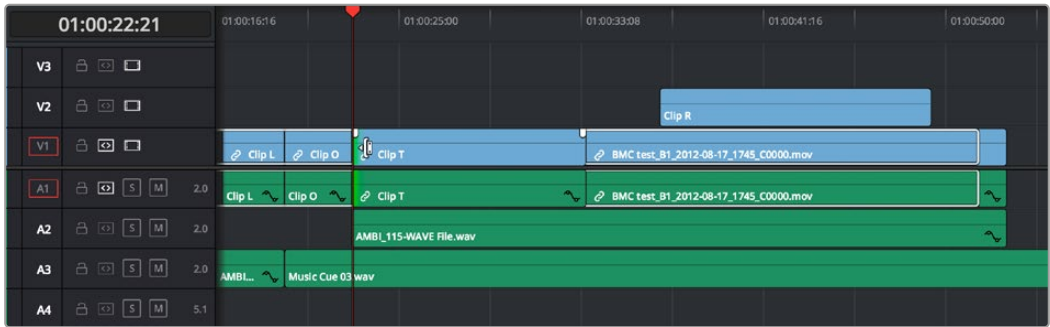
The rules are simple:

- **Tracks with Auto Select enabled:** Ripple editing or ripple deleting affects all clips to the right of the clip or clips on that track being trimmed.



Before and After, clip to the right of Clip T on tracks V2, V1, A1, and A2 are rippling because those tracks' Auto Select controls are enabled

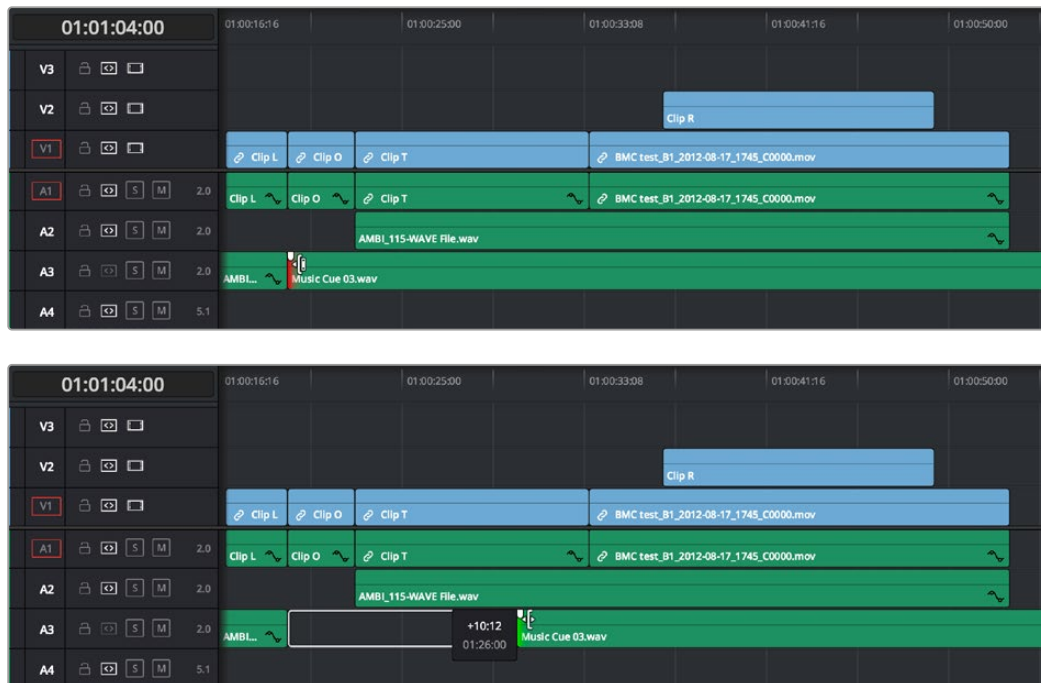
- **Tracks with Auto Select disabled:** Rippling is disabled on these tracks.



Before and After, clip to the right of Clip T on tracks V1 and A1 are rippling because those tracks' Auto Select controls are enabled, but clips on tracks V2 and A2 aren't rippling because those tracks' Auto Select controls are disabled

Another set of rules govern what happens when you select clips or edits for trimming on tracks with Auto Select disabled:

- **Selected Tracks with Auto Select turned off with an edit selection:** If you select the outgoing or incoming half of an edit on a track that has Auto Select off, the result will be a resize operation. Ripple deleting clips leaves a gap.



Before and After, clips to the right of Music Cue 03 on tracks V1, V2, A1, and A2 are rippling because Auto Select is enabled on those tracks, but because the clip being trimmed on track A3 has Auto Select disabled, it doesn't ripple, instead resizing to open up a gap

Trimming Multiple Edits or Clips at Once

DaVinci Resolve lets you select multiple edit points or clips for certain trimming operations, making it possible to trim multiple edits and clips at the same time. In simple cases, this makes it easy to resize, ripple, slip, and slide several superimposed clips at the same time, which is a real convenience, or you can select the In point of every title generator in a credit sequence at once in preparation for shortening or lengthening them all at once. In more complicated cases, this lets you create more complicated trimming scenarios, such as multi-track asymmetric trimming, to quickly take care of difficult tasks.

No matter how ambitious a trim operation you want to set up, the procedure is exactly the same as for an ordinary trim operation. Just make sure you follow these three general steps, and you'll be good:

- 1 Choose Selection mode, and select the edit points or clips you want to trim. To make multiple selections, click once to select the first item, then Command-click each subsequent item you want to add to the selection. You can select as many clips and/or edit points on as many tracks as you like.
- 2 To ripple, slip, or slide the entire selection at once, choose Trim mode. To resize or move each selected item at once, continue using Selection mode.
- 3 Use the mouse, keyboard shortcuts, or timecode entry to execute the trimming operation, just as you would if a single edit point or clip were selected.

The following sections describe each of the special-case multi-selection trim operations that are possible, along with each one's special rules and limitations.

Resizing and Rolling Multiple Edit Points

You can resize or roll multiple edit selections at once. In this way, you can adjust the edit points of multiple superimposed clips all together. Trimming multiple edit points essentially lets you “gang” them so that all selected edits move together as one.

- To resize multiple clips at once, select the left (outgoing) or right (incoming) half of each edit point you need to adjust, then use the Selection tool to drag those edit points to resize them all.
- To roll multiple clips at once, select every edit point you need to adjust right at the center, so that both the incoming and outgoing halves of each edit point are selected, then use either the Selection or Trim tools to drag those edit points to roll them all.

NOTE: You cannot combine ripple and roll operations at the same time.

Rippling Multiple Edit Points

It's also possible to select multiple incoming or outgoing edit points on either superimposed video tracks, or on the same video track, in order to ripple them all at once. A good example of when you'd want to ripple multiple clips on the same track is if you've got an end credit sequence of 14 text generators, and you'd like to shorten the entire sequence by a particular amount. This example can be seen below.

When you ripple trim multiple edits on the same track, how many frames are trimmed in a particular trim depends on what method you use to do your trimming.

- If you use the Trim tool via dragging in the Timeline, then you can choose to ripple the entire selection of edits by an arbitrary duration, for example, shortening or lengthening the entire selection by eight frames. To do this, DaVinci Resolve performs your multi-selection trim operation one edit at a time, removing a frame at a time from each selected edit from the left to the right as you trim, until either you stop the operation, or every single selected edit has had a frame removed, at which point DaVinci Resolve begins trimming the second frame from each selected edit from the left to the right, and then the third, and so on, until you stop trimming. Working this way, you can use the mouse to trim any number of clips to fit into any duration.
- You can also choose to ripple each selected edit by the same amount, for example removing three frames from each of the selected edits, all at once. To do so, hold the Command key down while dragging selected edits with the Trim tool, or use Dynamic JKL trimming, or trim by entering relative timecode values, or use the nudge keys (Period and Comma).

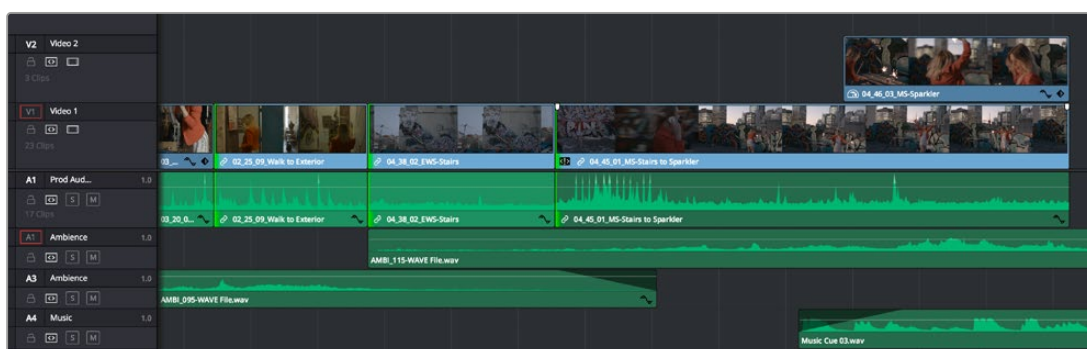
To ripple trim multiple edits on the same track:

- 1 Click the Trim tool, and drag a bounding box in the Timeline to select all 14 edits.
- 2 Press the U key to select the incoming half of each selected edit.
- 3 Use whichever trimming method you prefer to ripple the sequence to be shorter or longer. Dragging using the Trim tool lets you trim by an arbitrary number of frames, while holding the Command key down while dragging with the Trim tool, using timecode entry to trim, using the Comma and Period nudge keys, or using Dynamic JKL trimming lets you trim every selected edit by the same number of frames.

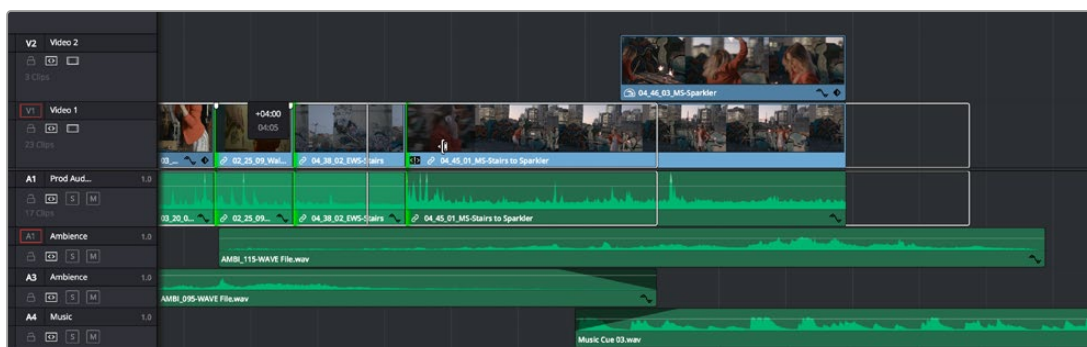


(Before) Selecting 14 incoming credits edit points, (After) Trimming them all at once

In the following example, the incoming edit of three clips in the following montage are selected and simultaneously rippled using the Trim tool. Notice that each overlapping clip ripples along with the nearest selected edit that's to the left of it; this means that the superimposed clip in track V2 and the audio clip in track A4 ripples along with the third selected edit, while the audio clip in track A2 ripples along with the second selected edit. Since the audio clip in track A3 starts to the left of the first selected edit, it does not ripple.



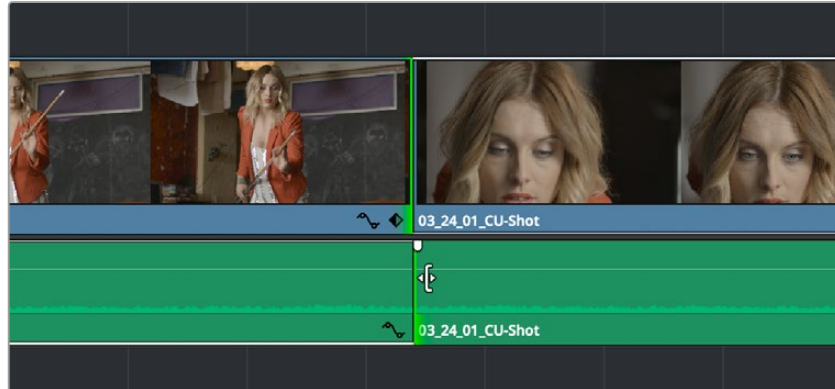
Selecting three incoming edit points,



Trimming them all at once

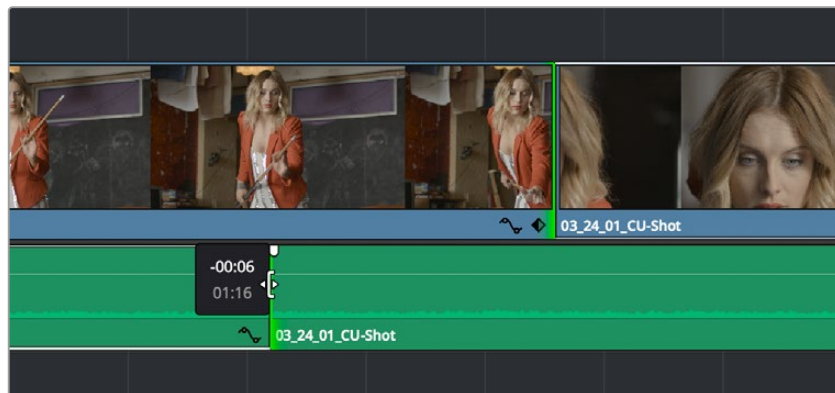
Asymmetric Trimming

Asymmetric resize or ripple trimming can also be done to multiple clips, with one selection per track allowable on as many tracks as you require. To asymmetrically trim two or more clips, select an outgoing edit point on one track, and then Command-click an incoming edit on another track.



Selecting opposite outgoing video and incoming audio edit points in preparation for performing an asymmetric ripple trim

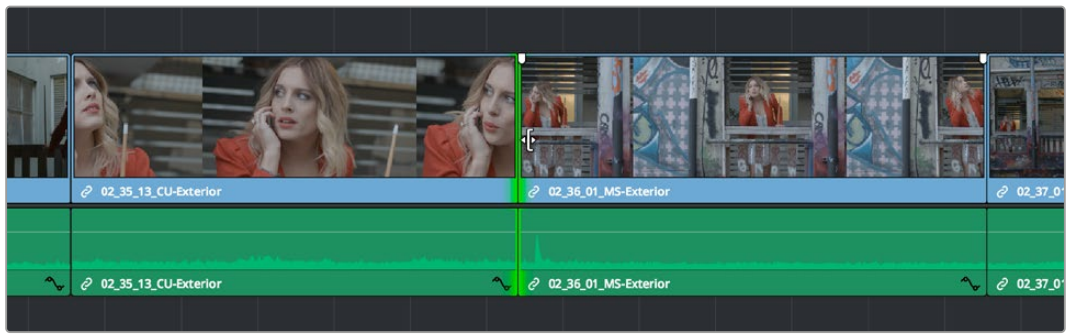
To select the outgoing video edit of one clip and the incoming audio edit of the next clip in preparation for making a split edit, you can Option-click the outgoing video edit to suspend linked selection, and then Command-click the incoming audio edit to add it individually to the selection. Now when you drag, nudge, or use timecode to trim, each selected edit point will move in the opposite direction.



Dragging to perform an asymmetric ripple trim to create a split edit using the Trim tool

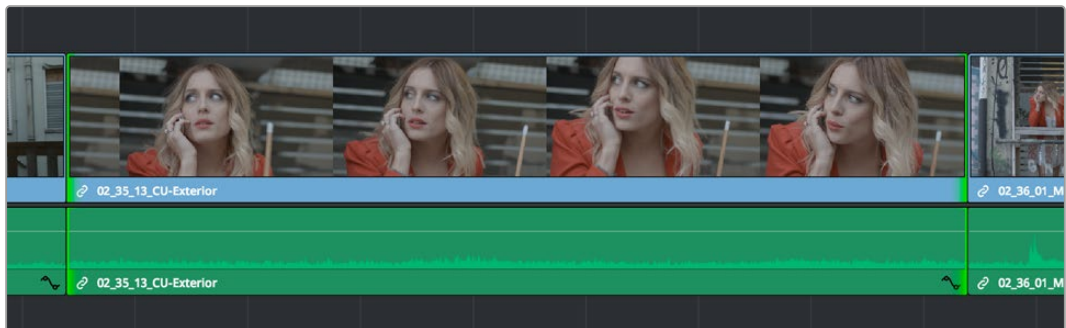
DaVinci Resolve allows you to do asymmetric trims to multiple edits in the same video and/or audio track. There are two compelling reasons for doing so:

Select the outgoing half of an edit point (the left side), then Command-click to select the incoming half of the same edit point (the right side) separately. This will not perform a roll edit, but will allow you to either use the Selection tool to resize both edit points away from each other to create a gap, or use the Trim tool to ripple both sides of the edit to shorten both clips while tightening up the Timeline at the same time.



Before and After ripple trimming both the incoming and outgoing halves of an edit to shorten the duration of both clips at once

You can also select the In and Out points of a clip in the Timeline at the same time, and use the Trim tool to ripple both the beginning and end of the clip closer to the center, shortening the clip while preserving the content in the middle, while tightening up the Timeline.

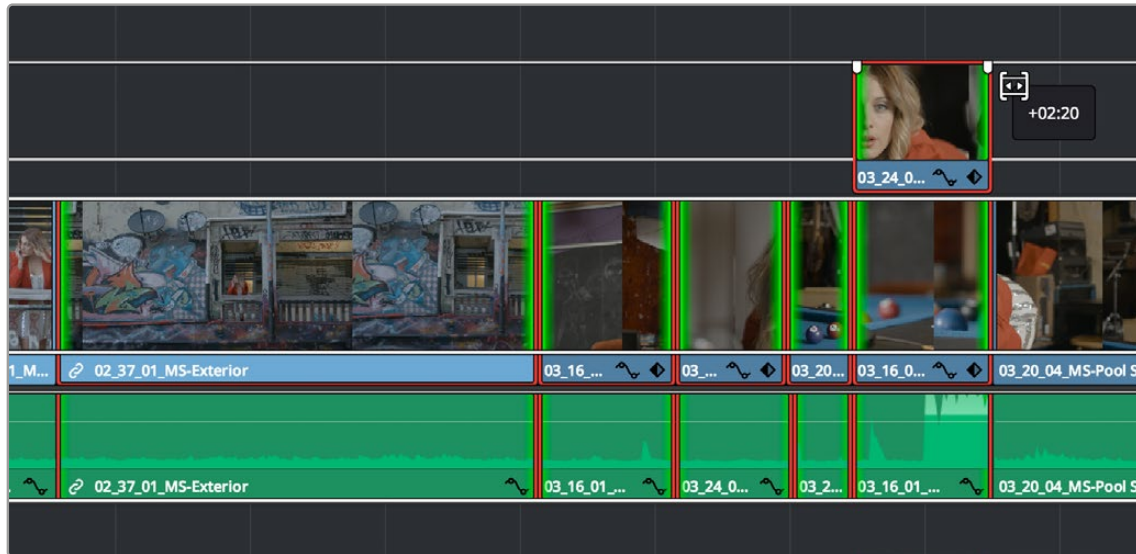


Before and After ripple trimming both the In and Out points of a clip at the same time, shortening the clip by removing heads and tails, and preserving the action in the middle

In short, you can use nearly any combination of edit selections you need to simultaneously trim multiple clips in the same track, in multiple tracks, whatever you need to do to save time. Furthermore, asymmetric trimming can be done in either Selection or Trim mode, either to open and close gaps, or to move edit points to overlap one another to create split edits.

Slipping Multiple Clips

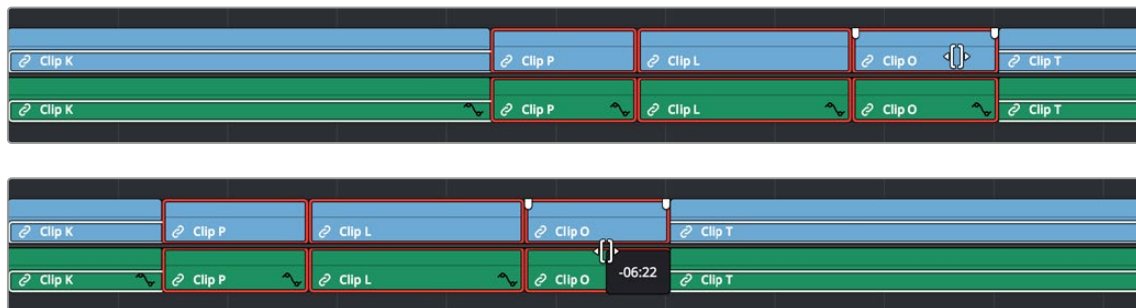
You can simultaneously slip any number of selected clips (so long as they have handles) on any combination of tracks by selecting the clips you want to slip, then choosing the Trim tool, and dragging their name bars or using the Comma and Period keys to nudge the selection.



Dragging to slip multiple selected clips at once

Sliding Multiple Clips

You can select as many clips as you like in preparation for a slide operation. If you select multiple contiguous clips, they slide together as one.



(Before) Selecting four clips to slide, (After) All four clips slid to the right using the mouse

Keyboard Trimming During Looped Playback

A great technique for editors who like to do precision trimming using the Nudge commands is the ability to enable looped-playback so that the Play Around command (Forward Slash) will loop continuously around the edit point you're trimming as you nudge one or five frames at a time to fine-tune the cut.

To trim while looping:

- 1 Move the playhead near the edit point you want to trim, and press V to select it.
- 2 Press the U to choose which side of the edit you want to select in order to ripple or roll it, and/or Option-U to choose whether you want to trim video+audio, the video only, or the audio only.
- 3 Press Command-Forward Slash (/) to enable looped playback.
- 4 Press Forward Slash (/) to play around the current selection. With looping on, playback will continue until you stop it. Pre-roll and post-roll can be changed in the Edit panel of the User Preferences.
- 5 During looped playback, press the Comma (,) and Period (.) keys to trim the selection back or forward by a single frame, or Shift-Comma and Shift-Period to trim the selection in 5-frame increments. If you do this during the post-roll of looped playback, the loop immediately replays from the beginning so you waste no time seeing the result.
- 6 When you're finished, press the Spacebar or K key to stop playback.

TIP: When holding down the Shift key while nudging to do a “fast nudge,” the duration of the nudge is customizable in the Editing panel of the User Preferences. By default it's five frames, but you can set it to whatever you want.

Dynamic JKL Trimming

One of DaVinci Resolve's most interactive trimming features is the ability to dynamically resize, ripple, roll, slip, slide, or move selected edit points and clips using the JKL transport control keyboard shortcuts. This means that you can make an appropriate selection in the Timeline (edit points to resize, ripple, or roll, or clips to slip or slide) then trim them during playback, while monitoring audio and watching the video.

Trimming while viewing the selected clip or edit point playing back has the advantage of letting you get emotionally involved in what you're watching, as well as experiencing the timing of a clip as it plays, in order to help you get a better feel for how, exactly, you need to trim a particular cut.

While you're dynamically trimming, you see the same two-up or four-up display, the same Timeline overlays, and the same dynamically updating Timeline that appear when you use the Trim tool with the mouse. The only difference is that you're trimming while your program plays.

There are two methods of doing dynamic trimming:

- **Quick Trim:** You can select one or more edit points or clips, and immediately trim it by pressing Command-J or Command-L to trim back or trim forward. This is a fast way of dynamically trimming, but you can only trim forward and backward at 100 percent speed or greater.
- **Turning on Dynamic mode:** If you want to do more detailed work, you can press the W key to enable Dynamic mode (or choose Trim > Dynamic Trim Mode), at which point you are in a special mode where the JKL shortcuts only trim the current selection, whatever it happens to be. However, this mode also gives you additional options for controlling which part of the selection, in the case of multiple selection trims, you want to monitor for audio/video playback.

TIP: If nothing is selected while you're in Dynamic Trim mode, JKL simply plays through the Timeline, as usual.

Quick Trimming

If you're in a hurry and you can accomplish the trim you want via real time or faster playback, then pressing the Command key while using the J or L keyboard shortcuts lets you dynamically trim any selection in the Timeline, with audio/video playback.

To dynamically trim using Command-J or Command-L:

- **To dynamically roll an edit:** In either Selection or Trim mode, select the center of one or more edit points, and hold the Command key down while using J or L to move the selection around.
- **To dynamically ripple an edit:** Choose Trim mode, select the outgoing or incoming half of one or more edit points, and hold the Command key down while using J or L to move the selection around.
- **To dynamically resize an edit:** Choose Selection mode, select the outgoing or incoming half of one or more edit points, and hold the Command key down while using J or L to move the selection around.
- **To dynamically move a clip:** Choose Selection mode, select one or more clips, and hold the Command key down while using J or L to move the selection around.
- **To dynamically slip or slide a clip:** Choose Trim mode, select one or more clips to slip, or a single clip to slide, press S to toggle between Slip or Slide modes, then hold the Command key down while using J or L to execute either slip or slide operations.

If you're trimming multiple selections, you can control which edit point you monitor during the trim operation by positioning the playhead at one of the selected edit points.

TIP: When you're finished with a "quick trim" operation and you want to see how that edit plays, you can press the Forward Slash key (/) to play around the current selection to quickly preview that section of the Timeline.

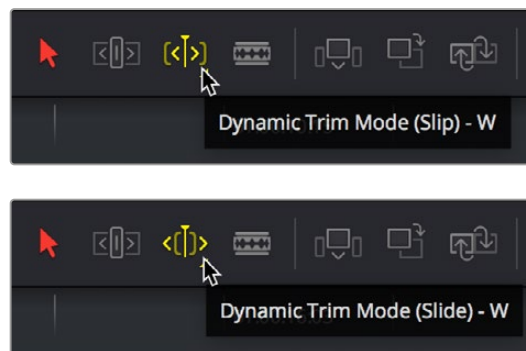
Dynamic Trimming (or “JKL Trimming”)

If you want to also have the option of trimming using the JKL shortcut keys in slow motion or frame by frame, in addition to trimming at 100% or greater playback speeds, then you'll need to enable Dynamic Trim mode.

To use Dynamic mode to dynamically trim one or more selected clips or edits:

- 1 It's not necessary to make a selection prior to enabling Dynamic mode for trimming, since the act of entering Dynamic mode automatically selects the closest edit point to the playhead. However, if you want to use Dynamic mode to make a complex trim operation, you can select any combination of edit points to resize, ripple, or roll, or you can select one or more clips that you want to slip or slide (using the S key to toggle between slipping and sliding).
- 2 Press W to enter Dynamic mode, or click the Dynamic tool in the toolbar. If nothing is selected in the Timeline, then the edit point that's nearest to the playhead will be automatically selected. If you've already made a selection, that selection will remain and be used for trimming.

Once you've entered Dynamic mode, the Dynamic Trim tool in the toolbar turns yellow to let you know that you're in Dynamic mode, and the icon shows you whether you're in Slip or Slide mode for trimming. Additionally, the playhead turns yellow to serve as a constant reminder that you're in Dynamic mode, in which all you can do is trim clips.



The Dynamic tool highlights in the toolbar to let you know you're in Dynamic mode; this tool also indicates whether you're in Slip (Left) or Slide (Right) mode

- 3 Choose the type of operation you want to perform by clicking either the Selection tool (or pressing A) or the Trim tool (or pressing T):

In Selection mode:

You can dynamically resize or roll edits if you've selected one or more edit points in the Timeline.

You can move or slip clips if you've selected one or more clips in the Timeline. You can choose whether to move or slip selected clips by pressing the S key, or by right-clicking the Dynamic trim tool in the toolbar and choosing Slip or Slide from the drop-down menu.

In Trim mode:

You can dynamically ripple or roll edits if you've selected one or more clips in the Timeline.

You can slide or slip clips if you've selected one or more clips in the Timeline. You can choose whether to slide or slip selected clips by pressing the S key, or by right-clicking the Dynamic trim tool in the toolbar and choosing Slip or Slide from the drop-down menu.

- 4 If you've selected multiple edit points or clips, then you can use the Left and Right arrow keys in Dynamic mode to move the playhead to the selected edit point you want to monitor while you're trimming. If the playhead isn't aligned with a selected edit point, then it will jump to the nearest selected edit point once trimming commences.

- 5 Use any combination of the JKL keyboard shortcuts to initiate playback and trimming, including:

J+K or K+L to trim in slow motion, with slow motion audio playback

Pressing K while tapping J or L to trim a frame at a time

Pressing J or L to trim with real time playback

Pressing J or L repeatedly to trim in fast-reverse or fast-forward, at a variety of speeds

As you dynamically trim, all audio clips in all audio tracks will play back as the playhead scrolls across them, so you can hear your entire mix as you're trimming.

- 6 After you've made a trim, pressing the Spacebar initiates Play Around Current Selection so you can see how that trim plays.

In Dynamic mode, the Spacebar only executes a Play Around Current Selection operation, rather than play forward as it usually does. What is played by Play Around Current Selection depends on what is selected; a selected edit plays around just that edit, a selected clip plays around the whole clip, multiple clips or edits play around the total selection, including the current Pre-Roll and Post-Roll settings in the Editing panel of the User Preferences.

- 7 When you're finished, you can use the Up and Down Arrow keys to move both the selection and playhead to another edit point or clip you'd like to trim, or you can press W again to toggle Dynamic mode off.

You always want to be sure to turn Dynamic mode off when you're done, because otherwise using JKL will continue trimming selections whenever one or more edits or clips are selected, instead of playing the Timeline.

NOTE: While Dynamic mode is enabled, you can use JKL for playback if no clips or edit points are selected (press Command-Shift-A to deselect all). However, if anything in the Timeline is selected, then JKL will trim the selection as described above.

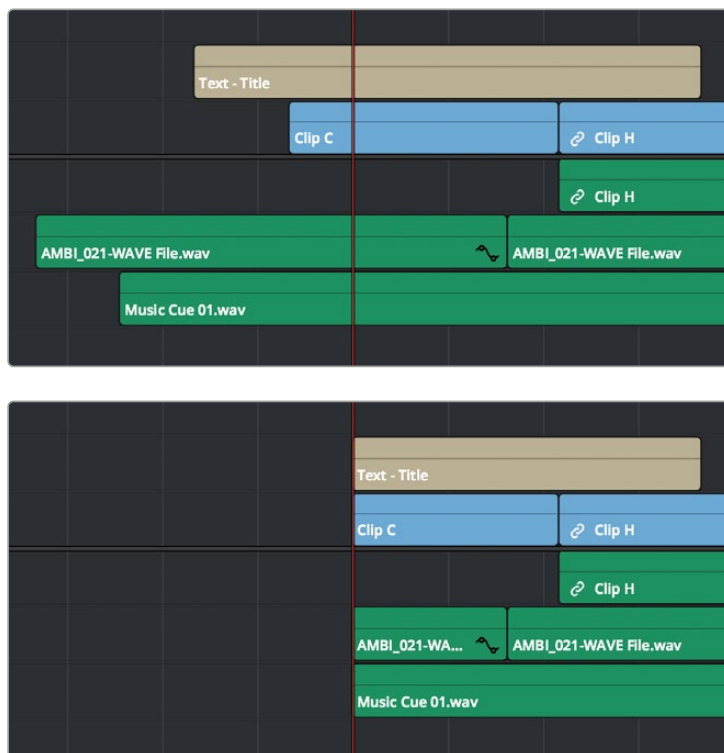
Trim Operations that are Targeted Using the Playhead

The following series of Trim editing commands let you trim clips and edits in different ways using the position of the playhead to guide the result.

Trim Start and Trim End

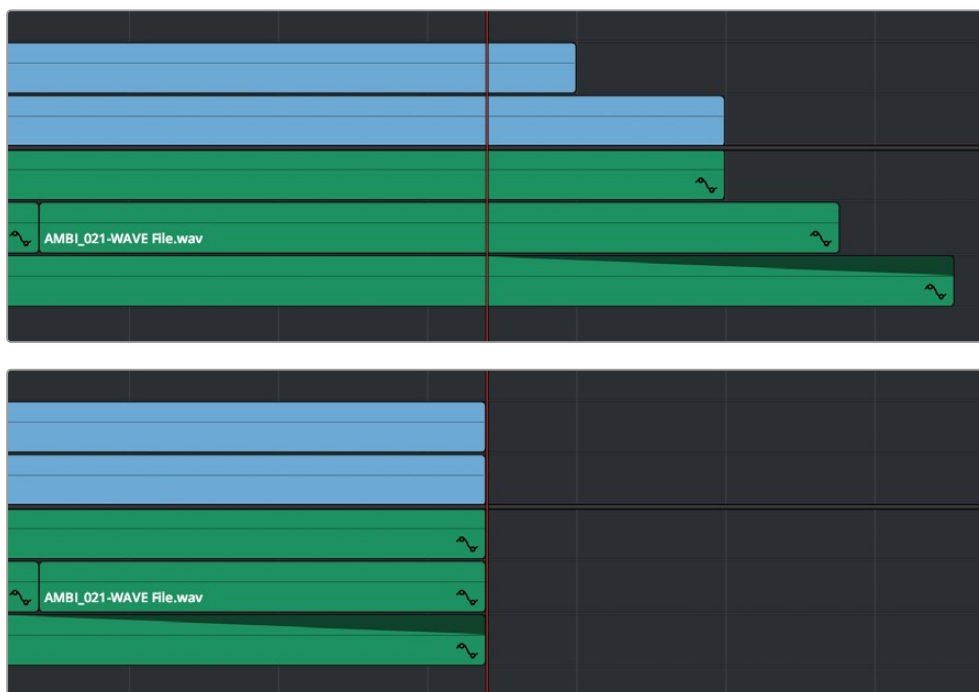
The Trim > Trim Start (Shift-I) and Trim End (Shift-J) commands let you move the In or Out point of all clips that intersect the playhead as either a ripple operation (in Trim mode) or a resize operation (in Selection mode). You do not need to make a selection to use Trim Start and Trim End, making these commands fast to use in the right situation. A classic use of Trim End is when you have several superimposed clips of different lengths that you want to either start or end at the same time.

- Trim Start resizes or ripples (depending on what mode you're in) all clips that intersect the playhead, so that each clip's In point is moved to the current playhead position.



Before and after a Trim Start operation, all clips that intersect the playhead are trimmed

- Trim End resizes or ripples intersecting clips so that each intersecting clip's Out point is moved to the current playhead position.



Before and after a Trim End operation, all clips that intersect the playhead are trimmed; clips that don't intersect the playhead are not affected

Clips that don't intersect the playhead are not affected. Furthermore, you can exclude clips on specific tracks from this operation by disabling the Auto Select controls on those tracks.

Resize, Ripple, and Roll Start and End Commands

Another set of commands in the Trim menu lets you combine the Trim Start and Trim End functions with the act of choosing either Selection or Trim mode, and the ability to resize, ripple, or roll, all with single commands.

- Resize Start to Playhead
- Resize End to Playhead
- Ripple Start to Playhead (Command-Shift-[)
- Ripple End to Playhead (Command-Shift-])
- Roll Start to Playhead
- Roll End to Playhead

Just as with Trim Start and Trim End, these commands use the Timeline Auto Select controls to determine, of all clips intersecting the playhead, which clips on which tracks to trim. Many of these commands don't have keyboard shortcuts by default, but if you prefer this way of working, you can assign them to keyboard shortcuts of your choosing using the Keyboard Mapping Customization tool (Option - Command - K).

Slip and Slide Playhead to In and Out Commands

Yet another set of commands in the Trim menu lets you slip a clip from the frame at the current position of the Playhead to the In or Out point of that clip.

- Slip Playhead to In
- Slip Playhead to Out

TIP: The Slip Playhead to In command functions identically to using the extend edit while the playhead intersects a selected clip.

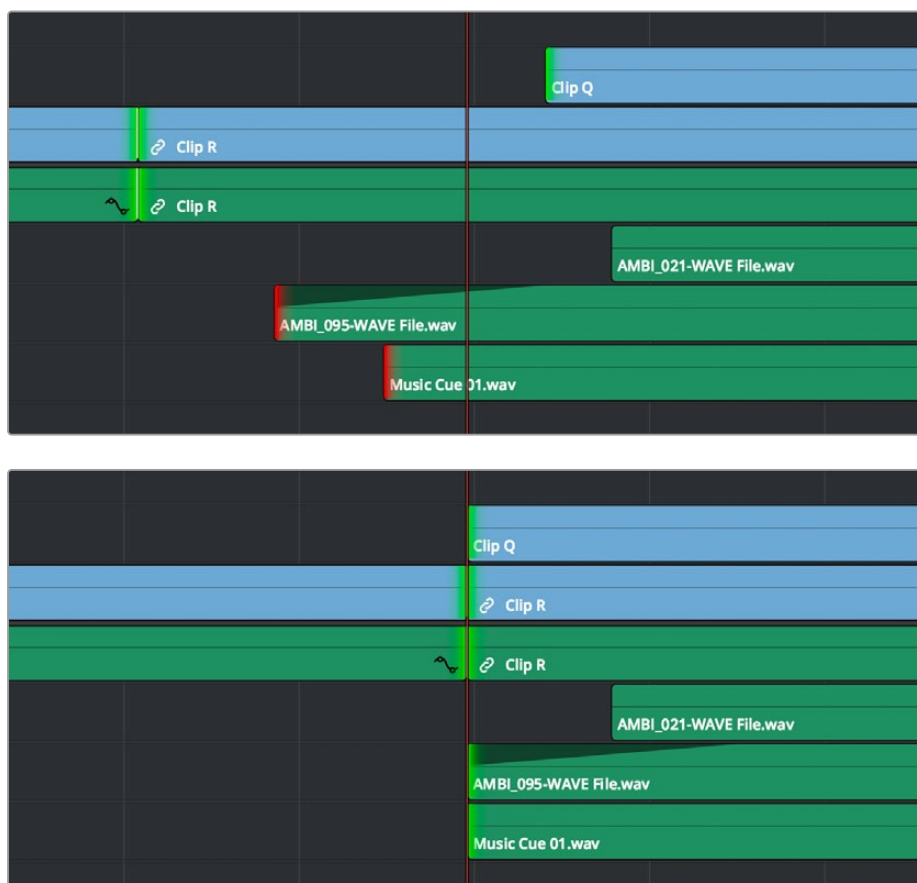
Just as with Trim Start and Trim End, these commands use the Timeline Auto Select controls to determine, of all clips intersecting the playhead, which clips on which tracks to trim. These commands don't have keyboard shortcuts by default, but if you prefer this way of working, you can assign them to keyboard shortcuts of your choosing using the Keyboard Mapping Customization tool (Option - Command - K).

Extend Edits

The Extend Edit command (choose Trim > Extend Edit, or press E) lets you resize or ripple one or more selected edit points or clips. Unlike Trim Start and Trim End, it doesn't matter if the playhead intersects clips when doing an extend edit.

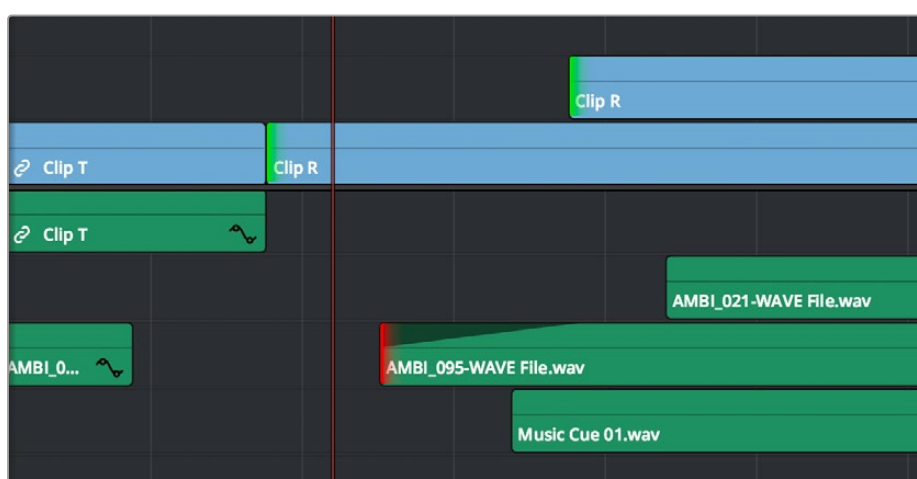
Extend Editing Edit Points

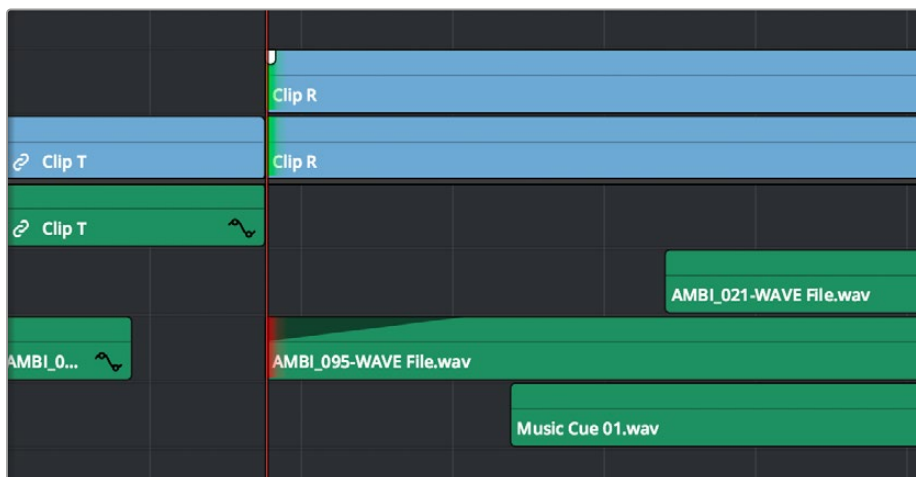
Make one selection per track of any combination of In or Out points, and press the E key to move those edit points to the current position of the playhead.



Before and after a multi-track extend edit performed in Selection mode. Before, the red selections indicate that you've selected the first frame of media for those clips. After, the selections turn green to indicate that there's additional frames at the head of the edit for trimming.

In Trim mode, selected edit points will ripple instead of resizing affected clips. However, to simplify multi-track extend edit operations when using the Trim tool, the lowest numbered video track with auto-select enabled defines the amount by which the extend edit will ripple the rest of the Timeline; all selected edit points on other tracks are simply resized to the position of the playhead.

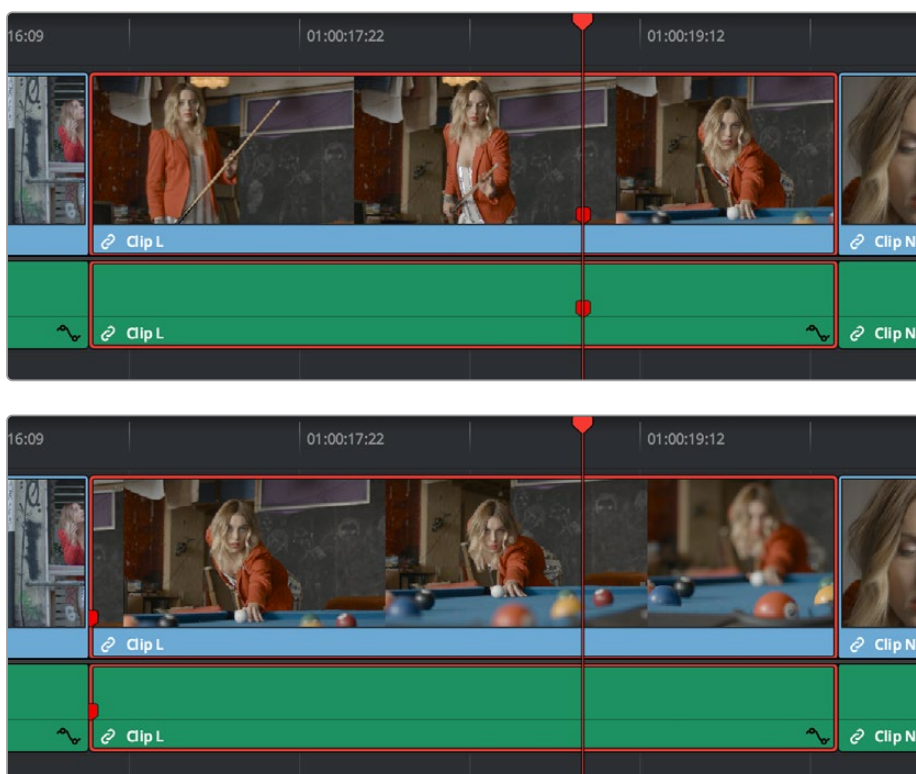




Before and after a multi-track extend edit performed in Trim mode; you can see that the lowest numbered track with a selection defines how far the Timeline will be rippled

Using Extend Edits to Slide Clips

You can also use the Extend Edit command to slide the contents of a single selected clip using either the Selection or Ripple tools. Simply select a clip, position the playhead over the frame of that clip you want to slip to the In point of that clip's position in the Timeline, and press E to perform the slip. You can even do this during playback if you want to watch the clip play and press E to slip that frame back when the moment feels right.



Using the extend edit to slip a clip in the Timeline, the red marker shows that the frame at the playhead is slipped back to the In point of that clip in the Timeline